Kestrel Health

- Physiotherapy for the workforce, in 48 hours.
- Seed round, May 2024.
- Priya Raghunathan, Callum Fairbairn, Mateusz Kowal

The problem

- Musculoskeletal problems are the #1 cause of sick days in the UK (around 30 million days a year).
- NHS physiotherapy waiting time: 14 weeks median in England.
- Insurer MSK pathways: 10 to 12 days to first appointment, limited choice.
- Employers pay for the absence either way and have no data.

The solution

- Employer gives staff access to Kestrel. Employee books a physio in 2 clicks.
- First appointment within 48 hours at a vetted local clinic (or video triage same day).
- Employer dashboard: utilisation, time to treatment, return-to-work.
- Clinics fill off-peak slots. We take a 20% platform fee.

Why now

- NHS MSK waiting lists doubled since 2020.
- Labour shortage in logistics, care and manufacturing makes absence a hiring problem.
- Private physio is fragmented (6,000+ UK clinics), under-utilised, no aggregator.
- Employers now have budget for 'wellbeing' and want something clinical.

Market

TAM £4.2B

- UK corporate health and wellbeing benefits spend: approx. £30B per year.
- MSK-related share (treatment, OH referrals, absence programmes): approx. 14%.
- Serviceable today: employers with 250+ staff in England.

Traction (April 2024)

- 9 employers live (pilots and paid), 6,100 covered employees.
- 62 partner clinics in London and Manchester.
- GMV £38k in April, growing 40% month on month.
- Time to first appointment: 2.4 days average.
- Net Promoter Score (employees): 71.

Business model

- Employer pays per booking (no PEPM fee at this stage), clinic pays 20% platform fee.
- Average session £62, 5 to 6 sessions per case.
- Target gross margin 55%+ after triage and payment costs.
- Later: PEPM prevention subscription, OH referral management.

Competition

- Insurer MSK pathways (Bupa, AXA, Vitality): slow, no employer data.
- US digital MSK (Hinge, Sword): digital only, not in UK employer market.
- Owned clinic chains: cannot scale supply.
- Us: in-person network + employer sale + outcomes data.

Team

- Priya Raghunathan, CEO. Ex Head of Corporate Propositions at a UK health insurer. MSc Health Econ, LSE.
- Callum Fairbairn, COO. Chartered physio, built and sold a 4-site clinic group.
- Mateusz Kowal, CTO. Ex staff engineer, payments infrastructure.
- Advisors: Dr. Imogen Hale (OH), Rob Castellano (US digital MSK).

The ask

£2.4M

- Raising £2.4M seed.
- 18 months runway to: 40 employers, 250 clinics, £3M GMV run-rate, first outcomes study.
- Use of funds: 50% product and engineering, 30% employer sales, 20% clinic network and clinical governance.